

October 2005

T L DIRECT

The Line Direct

COMMUNICATION: THE NERVOUS SYSTEM OF TLD

Like the human body, TLD consists of subsets and organs which work together, and are closely dependent.

The correct operation of one of them depends on the others.

A production site which manufactures a piece of equipment only exists because the sales entities sell its machines to the customer, and vice versa.

This site may also depend, for a part of its sourcing, on a department of another TLD site, which provides it subsets and components.

The sales organizations can sell only because the after sale service puts the equipment into service, and develop customers loyalty by an effective support. But how would the sales and after sales departments live without a reliable spare parts service?

These departments, or bodies, must be well coordinated, otherwise it is the whole Group that will suffer, will not function correctly, or even, will perish.

This coordination is ensured by a nervous system, and at TLD, this nervous system is the COMMUNICATION between the services and entities of the Group. They are obviously several communication channels, and the electronic means, e-mail and the TLD Web site, have become an essential vector during the last 10 years.

Should a person, or entity, in the chain of the missions and responsibilities, communicate badly, it will inevitably affect the whole Group. This is the reason why we have recently adopted a Group Communication Chart.

This Chart is not just "one more rule or procedure", or a civility code, but an essential rule of the life of our Company. It has to be respected by all, for a healthy future of TLD!

Jean-Marie FULCONIS

The Latest Dispatch

MUNICH 2005: A GREAT VINTAGE

This year, MUNICH has been a GREAT SHOW, by the quantity, the diversity and the quality of the visitors whom we had the opportunity to welcome on our TLD booth.



A GREAT SHOW because, again this year, TLD has innovated and demonstrated its technological know how, in the new challenge of entering the market of the towbarless tractors for high speed maintenance towing (up to 32 Km/h) of the wide body aircraft, including the new A 380 super jumbo. This tractor, which benefits from highly appraised design principles used by the whole TLD range of towbarless tractors, really attracted many visitors, and even connoisseurs whose visit is a proof of success : Our main competitors themselves!

A GREAT SHOW because each Area Sales Manager received the visit of many of its customers - more than one hundred - as well as of many TLD potential customers, who came to visit us with focused questions, in particular from Germany, Eastern European countries and England.

A GREAT SHOW because it is the first time since September 11, 2001, that our customers really came to discuss technical details, price and even new orders. Indeed, some also came to expose their problems, and the solutions to be implemented.

A GREAT SHOW where TLD has again demonstrated its dedication to the GSE, its capacity and its worldwide presence, and its willingness to become our customers' PARTNER, ADVISOR...and even better :

A REFERENCE!

It is also during these moments that we have the risk to create a frustration among customers, in case we can not devote enough time to each of them. Fortunately, the party offered by TLD to its customers, on the evening of the first day, illustrated once again, by its atmosphere and its success, the professionalism and quality of relation that the TLD team aims at instituting with our CUSTOMERS-PARTNERS.

Our road is a long and difficult one, but it leads us to our goal : to make TLD N° 1.

But the road ahead is even more challenging :

***TO KEEP THE CONFIDENCE OF OUR CUSTOMERS
AND NOT TO DISAPPOINT THEM !***

The Latest Dispatch

From now on TLD must have the ambition to offer an EXCELLENT support to its customers, whatever its size and status : small or large, local or global. Many efforts must still be made to achieve this goal: we are implementing the means, we have the ambition, but we still have to make it happen.

Cheer to the TPX-500-MTS team in Montlouis who has successfully struggled to make the latest TLD towbarless tractor one of the highlights of the Munich show, and thus contributed to maintain the image of TLD at the highest level.

Thank you to TLD America for the interior booth furniture, which brought a new professional touch to our booth (even if certain details can and must always be improved in the future).

CHEER to all our colleagues who took part in the success of the Inter Airport Show 2005 in MUNICH and, in particular, sincere thanks to Isabelle, Don and Christoph for their active participation in the organization of this major event in the life of the TLD Group.

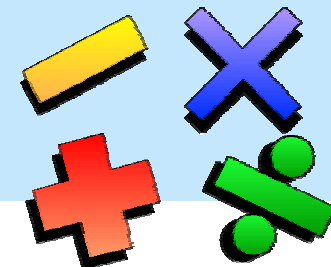
Jacques ROUX

The Latest Dashboard

T L Dash board (in M€uros)

(Year to date-end of **SEPTEMBER** figures)

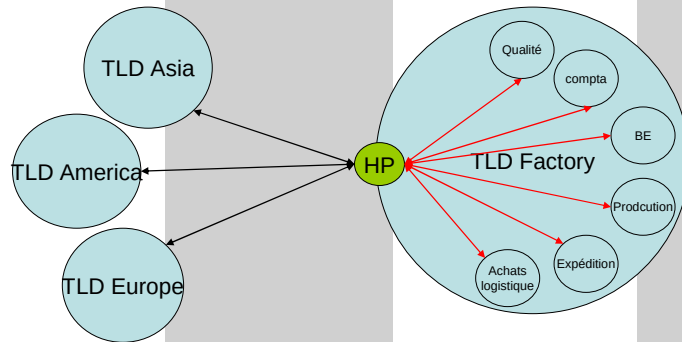
TLD Sales	2005/09		2005/2004 % Evolution
	in M€uros	in % of total	
GSE - AREA AMERICA (Americas, Australia, Japan, N. Zealand)	25,858	26,4%	11,9%
GSE - AREA EUROPE (Europe, Africa, middle east, India, Pakistan)	42,906	43,9%	47,7%
GSE - AREA ASIA (w/o Taiw an TRVD)	14,339	14,7%	26,5%
Other activities (Adhésives solutions+Taiw an TRVD+Actiparts)	14,679	15,0%	<7,0>%
TOTAL TLD SALES	97,782	100%	23,3%



TLD Life Digest

TLD Product Support Manager: a difficult key mission

The product support function is a **key communication function** within TLD. Without the PSM, the group organization simply would not work because he is the key link between the TLD factories and the TLD Sales Entities.



Think of these numbers for a minute:

- 1 PSM per factory
- 20 Area Sales Managers calling all the time
- 25 Field Technicians demanding assistance
- 50 to 100 people in each TLD factory always too busy to help the PSM

This is why it is so important for the Sales entities to only ask the PSM to do what he is supposed to do and for the PSM factory colleagues to provide their PSM more internal support.

On one side, the Product Support Manager is not there to do the job of the Sales Entity

- The PSM supports the Area Sales Manager but is not there to do the basic sales job of understanding the customer request and analyzing the customer technical specifications, which is a Sales function.
- The PSM provides technical support to the Service teams but is not there for day to day troubleshooting, which is a Service function.
- The PSM helps the reception of customers in the factory. However, customer visits management is a Sales function.
- The PSM needs clear and diligent feedback from the sales entities on field issues, otherwise solutions to problems cannot be developed.

On the other side, the Product Support Manager needs good proactive support from his factory colleagues

- The PSM can only provide lead-times if diligent and reliable info from the manufacturing side is provided.
- The PSM is not supposed to be a technical expert. Support from the engineering and test departments is required whenever problems arise in the fields that are too complicated, or whenever the PSM workload may jeopardize diligent feedback to the field technician.
- The PSM is responsible for uploading Equipment records and On-line manuals but needs active support from other departments to do so (Manufacturing, Quality and Engineering).

Our goal in TLD is to develop and maintain our position as the world leader in customer support. This can only be achieved with a top reactivity and professionalism at the PSM function level. No matter what, this key COMMUNICATION link in the chain of support must not be broken.

Help and respect the PSM !!

Antoine MAGUIN

The Last Development of TLD Canada

The first giant cargo loader DBL110 becomes reality with its first major weldments being under construction



The production of the giant cargo loader for BOEING started last August at TLD Canada in Sherbrooke. A partnership was agreed with the supplier who already produces the main 828/929 chassis, in order to fabricate the major weldments directly inside the TLD factory (platforms, chassis, scissors). This decision allows eliminating the logistic cost of these big pieces. Indeed, each of the platform and the chassis steel structure weigh 44 000Lbs, and respectively show up impressive 109 x 22ft and 91 x 19ft dimensions.



This is the reason why these pieces will be sand blasted and painted on site. To do so, a temporary double function booth, for sand blast and paint (120 x 30ft booth), is going to be installed inline with the future production assembly area (planned to be removed at the end of the project).

Since the beginning of the project last February, BOEING strictly validates every milestone of the design phase during engineering review meetings clearly planned on the contract. Then, in accordance with our schedule, the Engineering phase is now complete. BOEING is in a validation process of this important milestone which drives the "Approval for production".



The unit assembly will start beginning of December of this year and be completed in September 2006 for the initial 5 unit contract. The first unit will be shipped in May 2006. The addition to purchase more units is under evaluation within BOEING, dependant upon the growth of their 787's; confirmation will be known 2006.

Philippe TESSIER

TLD people

THE AFTER SALE SERVICE TEAM OF TLD EUROPE (RUNGIS)

Do you know them?

They know (almost) everything!

Our machines have no secret from them

They are everywhere!

They have to adapt to different climates and languages almost on a daily basis

They are available to travel to (almost) all destinations, upon a simple call.

They are the TROUBLESHOOTERS.

They put our machines into service.

They train customers' technicians and operators.

REPAIR, SERVICE BULLETINS, RETROFIT, SERVICE MODULE, INTERVENTION REPORT, COMMUNICATION, we request all that from them !

They are the essential link between our customers and our engineering departments. In certain situations, they can also be an essential mediator between our customers and our Sales managers.

Since the beginning of the 2005, among other important missions, they have spent 187 days to put 172 new pieces of equipment into service (on a total of 469 machines delivered to our customers on the TLD Europe area) that is to say 1,08 Days per machine.....

We owe them our respect, and our thanks.

Jacques ROUX

... TLD AFTER SALES TEAM

... VARIOUS SKILLS



Arnould BOUQUET
Customers Service &
Spare Parts Manager



Frederic SILVA
Technical Support



Sylvie LECOMPTE
Administrative Assistant



Emmanuel COLLINEAU



Fabrice JUBERT



Claude MEURISSE

... AT YOUR DISPOSAL !



Marc BERMENT



Grégory GADIN



Guy MICHOD